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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

TUESDAY, 13 OCTOBER 2026

13 must-know stories, 25 Prelims facts, 16 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 938 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

SC seeks caste verification SOP under Census

The Supreme Court asked the Centre to spell out the mechanism available under Census 2027 to identify fake claims by OBC, SC, and ST persons. A bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant observed that legitimate rights of genuine people cannot be taken away by false claims. The court was hearing a PIL filed by Delhi-based social activist Aakash Goel seeking safeguards for recording and verifying caste particulars. The petitioner argued that the August 14 notification under Section 8(1) of the Census Act, 1948 does not specify a mechanism for checking caste certificate authenticity. The petitioner previously filed an RTI application to know the verification mechanism, but no details were provided by authorities. The bench asked Solicitor General Tushar Mehta to take instructions and file a note indicating the standard operating procedure after two weeks. The petition noted that recorded caste status is statutorily linked to reservation entitlements in education, public employment, and legislative representation. Inaccurate enumeration without verification safeguards may distort numerical assessments, policy priorities, welfare targeting, and resource distribution.

When: 2026-10-13 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court, CJI Surya Kant, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, Aakash Goel · **Prelims:** Census 2027 allows caste details to be filled as per the petition.; A notification under Section 8(1) of the Census Act, 1948 was issued on August 14.; The Supreme Court bench was headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the judicial scrutiny over data collection integrity in upcoming national censuses.; Addresses the risk of inaccurate demographic enumeration distorting welfare policies and reservation benefits.*

Static — The Census in India is conducted under the provisions of the Census Act, 1948, which empowers the central government to notify and conduct a census. Section 8(1) of the Census Act, 1948 authorizes the collection of specified information, which can include details concerning scheduled castes and scheduled tribes. Articles 15(4) and 16(4) of the Indian Constitution empower the state to make special provisions for the advancement of any socially and educationally backward classes or for SCs and STs.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy, Social Justice & Welfare · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Judgment

Hindustan Times: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Citing 50% cap, Karnataka HC strikes down law to hike quota for SC/ST

The Karnataka High Court struck down provisions of a 2022 law that increased reservations for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in educational institutions and state government jobs. A division bench comprising Chief Justice Vibhu Bakhru and Justice KS Hemalekha declared Section 3 and Section 4 of the Act unconstitutional for breaching the 50% reservation ceiling. The core issue involved balancing affirmative action demands against the constitutional 50% limit established by the Supreme Court in 1992. The 2022 law increased SC quota from 15% to 17% and ST quota from 3% to 7%, pushing total reservations in the state from 50% to 56% while OBC quota remained at 32%. The Act received governor assent in January 2023 under the previous BJP government, with retrospective effect from November 1, 2022. The court ruled that Section 3 violated Articles 14 and 15, and Section 4 violated Articles 14 and 16 of the Constitution. The petitions were filed by individuals including a social worker and civil engineering graduates challenging quota hikes in Bengaluru municipal recruitment.

When: 2026-10-13 · **Where:** Karnataka · **Who:** Chief Justice Vibhu Bakhru, Justice KS Hemalekha, Karnataka High Court · **Prelims:** The Karnataka High Court bench was led by Chief Justice Vibhu Bakhru and Justice KS Hemalekha.; The law increased SC reservation from 15% to 17% and ST reservation from 3% to 7%.; The 2022 law received the governor's assent in January 2023.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reaffirms the judicial boundary of the 50% reservation ceiling set in the Indira Sawhney judgment.; Highlights procedural mandates regarding consultation with constitutional bodies like NCSC and NCST.*

Static — The 50% ceiling on total reservations was famously laid down by the Supreme Court in the landmark Indira Sawhney v. Union of India case in 1992. Article 15 of the Constitution prohibits discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth, while enabling special provisions for socially and educationally backward classes. Article 16 guarantees equality of opportunity in matters of public employment and permits reservation of appointments in favor of any backward class.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare · Prelims angle: Judgment

scroll.in: read the source · also reported by The Hindu, Business Standard, NDTV

GS2 MAKE NOTES

SC issues notice to Centre, ECI on plea challenging blanket immunity to CEC, ECs

The Supreme Court issued notice to the Centre and the ECI on a PIL challenging blanket immunity for the CEC and Election Commissioners under Section 16 of the 2023 Act. The plea was filed by the Association for Democratic Reforms, arguing that Section 16 grants sweeping protection from civil and criminal proceedings for official acts. The petitioner contended that the provision violates Articles 14 and 19 of the Constitution by undermining accountability and placing functionaries beyond ordinary legal processes. Section 16 protects serving and former CECs and ECs from court proceedings for acts done or words spoken while discharging official duties. The matter has been tentatively listed for further hearing by the apex court on November 2. This comes amid separate judicial scrutiny regarding whether the CEC can individually exercise powers vested in the multi-member ECI under Article 324. The constitutional validity of the 2023 law, which excluded the Chief Justice of India from the selection committee, is also under judicial scrutiny following a split verdict.

When: 2026-10-13 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court, Centre, Election Commission of India, Association for Democratic Reforms, CJI Surya Kant · **Prelims:** Section 16 of the 2023 Act grants immunity from civil and criminal proceedings to the CEC and ECs for official duties.; The Association for Democratic Reforms filed the PIL challenging the immunity provision.; The matter is tentatively listed for further hearing on November 2.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It tests the limits of legal immunity granted to key constitutional functionaries under parliamentary enactments.; It raises important questions regarding institutional accountability, judicial review, and the rule of law in India.*

Static — The Election Commission of India is a constitutional body established under Article 324 of the Constitution to superintend, direct, and conduct elections. The Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023 regulates the appointment and service conditions of poll panel members. Under the 2023 Act, the selection committee comprises the Prime Minister, the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, and a nominated Union Cabinet Minister.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution

thehansindia.com: read the source · also reported by Frontline, Live Law

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Delhi SIR: Plea in Supreme Court challenges ECI directive requiring deleted voters to enrol afresh

An application has been filed in the Supreme Court challenging the ECI requirement for voters excluded in Delhi's draft electoral rolls during the Special Intensive Revision to enrol afresh. The petitioners filed the application within their pending petition against the ECI to seek a separate mechanism for restoring names of previously enrolled voters. The core issue is that excluded voters must submit Form 6, which forces them to declare they are seeking enrolment for the first time. A total of 47,56,722 electors, constituting 32.78% of Delhi's electorate before the SIR, were excluded from draft electoral rolls published on August 31. Out of these excluded electors, 31,59,213 individuals were classified as permanently shifted. The petitioners argue this forces voters to make false declarations, which is punishable under Section 31 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950 with up to one year imprisonment, a fine, or both. The application also challenges an additional declaration prescribed under SIR instructions for imposing requirements beyond statutory Form 6 without following Section 28 procedures.

When: August 31, 2026 to October 4, 2026 · **Where:** Delhi · **Who:** Anjali Bhardwaj, Prashant Bhushan, Election Commission of India · **Prelims:** 47,56,722 electors were excluded from Delhi's draft electoral rolls published on August 31, making up 32.78% of the electorate.; 31,59,213 excluded voters were classified as permanently shifted.; Section 31 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950 penalises knowingly false declarations.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the legal and administrative complexities in mass electoral roll revisions and voter exclusions.; Raises important questions on statutory compliance, subordinate legislation, and citizen voting rights.*

Static — The Election Commission of India is an autonomous constitutional body responsible for administering election processes in India under Article 324 of the Constitution. The Representation of the People Act, 1950 provides for the allocation of seats and the delimitation of constituencies for elections to the House of the People and the Legislatures of States, along with the preparation of electoral rolls. Section 28 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950 empowers the Central Government to make rules after consulting the Election Commission, subject to parliamentary approval.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Bar & Bench: read the source

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Retrospective regularization of exempt status of Provident Fund (PF) Trusts through Amnesty Scheme, 2026

The Employees' Provident Fund Organisation urged eligible establishments pan-India to expedite submissions for the retrospective regularisation of exempt status under the Amnesty Scheme. The amnesty window was introduced as a transitional measure in the EPF Scheme 2026, notified on June 29, 2026. The core issue is that many Provident Fund Trusts are recognised under the Income Tax Act but lack formal exemption orders under the EPF&MP Act or Code on Social Security. The amnesty scheme offers a one-time opportunity for regularisation, remaining open for six months from notification until December 28, 2026. Key benefits include waivers of statutory requirements under the Code on Social Security such as minimum employee headcount, corpus size, and the 3-year compliance rule. The scheme also offers complete operational flexibility post-regularisation to comply either as an exempt or an un-exempt establishment. EPFO has partnered with bodies like CII, ICAI, and BSE to conduct awareness seminars and workshops for qualifying trusts and chartered accountants. The EPFO has coordinated with the Income Tax Department to institutionalize data sharing of exempted establishment records to bring non-compliant trusts under the statutory umbrella.

When: July 11, 2026 to December 28, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi, India · **Who:** Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) · **Prelims:** The amnesty window expires on December 28, 2026.; Provisions for amnesty were introduced in the EPF Scheme 2026 notified on June 29, 2026.; Apex industry bodies collaborating with EPFO include CII, ICAI, and BSE.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps bring unnotified or non-compliant PF trusts under the formal statutory umbrella without facing strict legacy penalties.; Protects continuing income tax benefits for trusts recognised by the Income Tax Department.*

Static — The Employees' Provident Fund Organisation is a statutory body under the Ministry of Labour and Employment, Government of India, responsible for regulation and management of provident funds. Section 17 of the Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952 provides for the power of the appropriate government to grant exemptions to certain establishments from the provisions of the scheme. The Code on Social Security, 2020 subsumes multiple central labour laws related to social security, consolidating provisions for provident funds, gratuity, maternity benefit, and cess.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Economy, Social Justice & Welfare · Prelims angle: Scheme, Act/Bill/Rules

PIB: read the source · free copy on telanganatoday.com · also reported by BusinessLine

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Government Datasets To Be Shifted To Indigenous Cloud Infra Ahead Of Data Protection Act Rollout

The Centre plans to shift lakhs of government datasets, including around 4.8 lakh open datasets, to indigenous cloud infrastructure like Shakti DB. The initiative aims to reduce dependence on foreign cloud providers such as Amazon Web Services and Google for hosting critical information. The migration is planned to take place ahead of the implementation of key provisions of the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023. A high-level meeting on October 7 evaluated Shakti DB's capabilities, security guardrails, and governance policies for managing ministry and department workloads. The wider government data ecosystem includes around 16,000 datasets from multiple ministries that need evaluation for secure indigenous hosting. The transition requires distinguishing between publicly available open datasets and sensitive personal records that demand stricter safeguards against unauthorized access. Discussions also covered cybersecurity, storage capacity, interoperability, service reliability, and departmental responsibilities for monitoring stored data. Substantive compliance provisions of the DPDP Act are scheduled to take effect on May 13, 2027, setting the timeline for the migration. Officials noted that moving to an Indian cloud provider does not automatically guarantee legal compliance, making proper access policies and data localisation distinct necessities.

When: 2026-10-13 · **Where:** India · **Who:** The Centre and government ministries · **Prelims:** Around 4.8 lakh open datasets are targeted for migration.; A meeting discussing Shakti DB capabilities was held on October 7.; Substantive compliance provisions of the DPDP Act, 2023 are scheduled to take effect on May 13, 2027.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces strategic vulnerability and technological dependence on foreign cloud service providers.; Enhances national cybersecurity, data sovereignty, and protection of sensitive personal records.*

Static — The Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023 sets the legal framework for processing digital personal data in India while recognizing individuals' rights to protect their data. Data localisation mandates that certain critical or sensitive data generated within a country must be stored and processed within national physical borders. Indigenous cloud infrastructure refers to domestically developed and hosted cloud computing platforms that reduce reliance on foreign technology giants and enhance strategic autonomy.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Science & Technology, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

NDTV: read the source · free copy on ndtv.com

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

BIMSTEC adopts Delhi Declaration to counter terrorism

BIMSTEC countries approved the Delhi Declaration at the First BIMSTEC Home Ministers' Meeting, reaffirming commitment to regional peace and security. The declaration emphasizes combating cross-border terrorism, terror financing, radicalisation, drug trafficking, human trafficking, cybercrime, and organised crime. The grouping called for effective implementation of UN Security Council sanctions measures, including the 1267 Sanctions Committee. Member states agreed that security and development are intertwined, and regional cooperation must follow principles of sovereign equality and non-interference. The meeting approved the Convention against Trafficking in Persons and the BIMSTEC Plan of Action on Drug Control. An MoU on capacity building was agreed upon to combat money laundering and terror financing through intelligence and asset recovery. The grouping also approved a Plan of Action on Illicit Financial Flows and a Plan of Action for disaster preparedness. India offered expertise in police training, forensic investigations, and proposed a BIMSTEC Centre for Disaster Management in Jamnagar, Gujarat.

When: 2026-10-13 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** BIMSTEC member nations · **Prelims:** The Delhi Declaration was adopted at the First BIMSTEC Home Ministers' Meeting.; BIMSTEC comprises seven member countries: Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Thailand.; The grouping approved the BIMSTEC Plan of Action on Drug Control and the Convention against Trafficking in Persons.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Strengthens collective regional response mechanisms against cross-border terrorism and terror financing in South and Southeast Asia.; Institutionalizes security frameworks through new conventions on human trafficking, drug control, and anti-money laundering.*

Static — BIMSTEC (Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation) is an international organization of seven nations in South Asia and Southeast Asia. The member states of BIMSTEC are Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Thailand. It was founded on 6 June 1997 through the Bangkok Declaration to promote rapid economic growth and social progress in the region.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Internal Security

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on theprint.in · also reported by ThePrint, DD India, The Tribune, Kashmir News Service, ANI News, Hindustan Times, Mid-Day, www.nationpathindia.com, News On AIR, The Economic Times, The Times of India

Health

GS2 MAKE NOTES

WHO Pandemic Treaty and India’s Stakes

India participated in the UN High-Level Meeting in September 2026 to shape the emerging global legal regime led by the WHO Pandemic Agreement. The WHO Pandemic Agreement is a legally binding international treaty adopted by consensus at the 78th World Health Assembly under Article 19 of the WHO Constitution. The core debate centers on balancing national sovereignty and Global South interests with equitable access to life-saving medical countermeasures. Negotiated over three years via the Intergovernmental Negotiating Body, the treaty aims to reform international health security following the COVID-19 pandemic. The Agreement's entry into force requires finalisation of the Pathogen Access and Benefit-Sharing annex and ratification by 60 states under Article 33. Participating manufacturers during a pandemic emergency would provide WHO with access targeting 20% of their real-time production, with at least 10% as donations. The treaty integrates a One Health framework and supports technology transfer, regionalized manufacturing ecosystems, and a Global Supply Chain and Logistics Network. India seeks standardised, legally binding contracts governing pathogen access and benefit-sharing to ensure timely product access and technological capacity-building.

When: September-October 2026 · **Where:** Global · **Who:** World Health Organization, Intergovernmental Negotiating Body, India · **Prelims:** The WHO Pandemic Agreement was adopted by consensus at the 78th World Health Assembly under Article 19 of the WHO Constitution.; The FCTC ratified by India in 2004 was the first legally binding health convention in WHO history.; Entry into force of the Pandemic Agreement requires ratification by 60 member states under Article 33.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Positions India as a voice for the Global South in international health governance.; Safeguards India's domestic pharmaceutical manufacturing interests through predictable procurement and technology transfer.*

Static — The World Health Organization (WHO) is a specialised agency of the United Nations responsible for international public health, established in 1948 and headquartered in Geneva, Switzerland. The World Health Assembly (WHA) is the supreme decision-making body of the WHO, attended by delegations from all member states, responsible for determining policies and financing. The International Health Regulations (IHR) serve as an overarching legally binding framework of international law designed to prevent, protect against, and control the international spread of disease.

Syllabus: GS2: Health, International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

drishtiias.com: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Towards a TB-Free India

The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare launched the nationwide JOSH campaign across 11 states and 55 districts to mobilize youth networks, NCC cadets, and grassroots communities. The campaign aims to promote TB awareness, early detection, timely treatment, and treatment adherence while addressing social stigma. India's yearly emerging TB cases dipped by 21% between 2015 and 2024, outpacing the 12% global reduction. Domestic TB mortality contracted by 28% during the same period, while India achieved a treatment coverage rate of 92%. Over 46,118 Gram Panchayats have successfully qualified and received official TB-Free Panchayat certifications as of 2026. The National Tuberculosis Elimination Programme utilizes the Detect-Treat-Prevent-Build paradigm and the oral, 6-month BPaLM regimen for drug-resistant TB. Advanced digital and diagnostic tools, including AI-powered digital X-ray units and the AI Khushi chatbot, have been deployed across facilities. Key hurdles include private healthcare under-notification, nutritional vulnerability, social stigmatization, and geographical barriers in remote regions.

When: 2026-10-13 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Health and Family Welfare · **Prelims:** The JOSH campaign was launched across 11 states and 55 districts.; India's TB incidence dropped by 21% between 2015 and 2024.; The National Ni-kshay Poshan Yojana provides Rs. 1,000 monthly financial aid to notified TB patients.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reflects India's progress in outperforming global averages for TB incidence reduction and treatment coverage.; Highlights the shift towards a Jan Andolan model, integrating youth networks and grassroots participation to tackle social stigma.*

Static — Tuberculosis is a chronic, communicable airborne infectious disease caused by the bacterium Mycobacterium tuberculosis, primarily attacking the lungs. Latent TB infection occurs when bacteria reside in the body without causing sickness, whereas active TB develops when the immune system weakens. Pulmonary TB affects lung parenchyma and is contagious, while extra-pulmonary TB infects other body sites and is generally non-contagious.

Syllabus: GS2: Health

PIB: read the source · free copy on insightsonindia.com

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

IMF raises India’s FY27 growth forecast to 7% on strong domestic demand

The International Monetary Fund upgraded India's gross domestic product growth projection for 2026-27 to 7%, up from 6.4% projected in July. The 60-basis-point upward revision was driven by robust economic activity, supported by resilient domestic demand and a strong services sector. Despite higher growth projections, India faces external vulnerabilities from prolonged geopolitical tensions and high global crude oil prices. The IMF also revised India's growth estimate for 2027-28 upward to 7%, compared to its previous projection of 6.7%. Global economic growth is projected to expand by 3.1% in 2026 and 3.4% in 2027, driven partly by investments in artificial intelligence. The fund highlighted extreme global growth concentration, with just 32 economies accounting for 95% of total projected worldwide economic expansion. The baseline assumption for crude oil prices was raised to $95.74 per barrel for 2026, marking a 41% jump over the 2025 average. Elevated crude costs risk widening India's trade deficit, weakening the rupee, elevating domestic input costs, and constraining the Reserve Bank of India's monetary easing. Sustained economic resilience will depend on whether domestic consumption and investment can withstand external energy price shocks.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** International Monetary Fund and Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** The IMF's October World Economic Outlook raised India's FY27 growth forecast by 60 basis points to 7%.; India's FY28 growth forecast was upgraded from 6.7% to 7% by the IMF.; The IMF estimated global growth at 3.1% in 2026 and 3.4% in 2027.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's structural buffer of having a large domestic consumer market against slowing global export demand.; Underscores the macro-fiscal risk of crude oil dependency, which can widen India's current account deficit and fan imported inflation.*

Static — The International Monetary Fund is an international financial institution founded in 1944 at the Bretton Woods Conference, formally beginning operations in 1945. Headquartered in Washington, D.C., the IMF works to foster global monetary cooperation, secure financial stability, facilitate international trade, and reduce poverty. Voting power in the IMF is linked directly to quota subscriptions assigned to member nations, which reflect each member's relative size in the global economy.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, International Relations, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Data/Stats, Report/Index

BusinessLine: read the source · free copy on indiatoday.in · also reported by NDTV, THE WEEK, Economic Times, TradingView

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India’s food inflation surges to 7.74%, weak monsoon spikes prices amid El Niño risks

India's food inflation surged to 7.74% in September from 5.97% in August, driven by spiking vegetable prices and weak monsoon rains. The surge was triggered by deficient rainfall during the June-September season, leading to extreme drought conditions in agricultural states like Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, Punjab, and Haryana. Economists warn that price pressures could persist into 2027 if El Niño conditions intensify, threatening crop yields and the transition to the rabi season. Onion price inflation more than doubled to 108.09% in September from 48.78% in August, according to National Statistics Office data. Other major increases included ginger at 62.85%, garlic at 54.62%, and lemon at 36.41%, alongside rises in staple items like rice and tur dal. Crop-specific supply constraints, such as garlic production in Rajasthan dropping to 60% of previous levels and Nigerian crop failures impacting ginger, compounded the pressures. Global commodity price movements, crude oil input costs, and a low statistical base from the previous year also magnified the annual inflation rate. Crops like bajra, tur, maize, groundnut, rice, and soybean remain vulnerable in regions with rainfall deficits and limited irrigation.

When: September 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** National Statistics Office, India Meteorological Department, Madhavi Arora, Dipti Deshpande, Deepak Pareek · **Prelims:** India's food inflation reached 7.74% in September.; Onion inflation accelerated to 108.09% in September.; India received its lowest June-September rainfall in more than a decade.

> ***Why it matters —*** *High food inflation hurts household budgets, reduces purchasing power, and increases macroeconomic pressure on the Indian economy.; It directly impacts agricultural livelihoods and signals vulnerability in the rural economy due to climate variability and deficient rainfall.*

Static — El Niño is a periodic warming of sea surface temperatures in the Eastern Pacific every two to seven years that can last up to 12 months and disrupt global rainfall patterns. The National Statistics Office (NSO), under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation, is responsible for collecting and releasing key economic data including inflation figures in India. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) monitors weather, meteorological observations, and seismic activity, functioning under the Ministry of Earth Sciences.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Geography, Agriculture & Allied · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Hindustan Times: read the source

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

IITs, IISc, BITS Pilani among 19 fund managers under Rs 1 lakh crore RDI scheme

The Government of India approved the first cohort of 19 Second Level Fund Managers under the Rs 1 lakh crore Research, Development and Innovation Scheme. The first cohort includes 14 Alternative Investment Funds and five Focused Research Organisations with a total RDIF commitment of Rs 7,131 crore. The five Focused Research Organisations include entities linked to IISc Bengaluru, IIT Madras, IIT Bombay, and BITS Pilani. The Empowered Group of Secretaries approved these fund managers at a meeting held on October 8, 2026. Fund managers will channel capital to eligible technology enterprises undertaking research and innovation activities at Technology Readiness Level 4 and above. The fund managers are expected to mobilise private capital equivalent to their RDIF contribution to encourage private sector investment. The Research, Development and Innovation Fund is managed by an Independent Business Unit housed within the Anusandhan National Research Foundation. The EGoS also approved five additional technologies for coverage under the RDI Fund to support India's technological development and reduce import dependence.

When: October 8, 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Empowered Group of Secretaries, Anusandhan National Research Foundation, Department of Science and Technology · **Prelims:** Total RDIF commitment for the first cohort: Rs 7,131 crore; Number of approved Second Level Fund Managers: 19; Number of Focused Research Organisations approved: 5

> ***Why it matters —*** *Addresses the financing gap that historically limited private sector investment in emerging and strategic technologies in India.; Aims to help India transition from being a consumer of technology to developing globally competitive products.*

Static — The Anusandhan National Research Foundation was established to seed, grow, and promote research and development and foster a culture of research and innovation throughout India's universities, colleges, and research institutions. Alternative Investment Funds are privately pooled investment funds that collect capital from sophisticated investors, whether Indian or foreign, for investing in accordance with a defined investment policy. Technology Readiness Level is a method for estimating the maturity of technologies during the acquisition phase of a program, spanning from basic principles observed to actual system proven through successful deployment.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats, Scheme

indiatoday.in: read the source

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Indian Army gets Nagastra kamikaze drones: Solar Defence delivers largest consignment of loitering munitions to armed forces

The Indian Army has received 450 Nagastra-1R loitering munitions in a single consignment from Solar Defence and Aerospace Limited. The procurement was executed under an emergency purchase agreement following successful technical trials and Pre-Delivery Inspections. The delivery has been stationed at the Pulgaon Ammunition Depot, significantly bolstering the military's precision strike capabilities along strategic borders. The 9-kilogram fixed-wing UAV operates in kamikaze mode, using GPS guidance to achieve a 2-meter strike accuracy. It features a 30-minute flight endurance and a range of 15 km in man-in-loop mode and 30 km in autonomous mode. Powered by an electric propulsion system, the drone maintains a low acoustic signature and remains undetectable at altitudes over 200 meters. The system carries a 1-kilogram High Explosive Fragmenting Warhead alongside day and night surveillance cameras for soft-skin targets. It includes a parachute recovery mechanism to abort missions and enable reuse, with over 75 percent indigenous content developed by Economics Explosives Ltd and Z-Motion Autonomous Systems.

When: 2026-10-13 · **Where:** Pulgaon Ammunition Depot · **Who:** Indian Army, Solar Defence and Aerospace Limited, Economics Explosives Ltd, Z-Motion Autonomous Systems · **Prelims:** Quantity delivered: 450 Nagastra-1R loitering munitions.; Delivery location: Pulgaon Ammunition Depot.; Drone weight and range: 9 kg drone weight, 15 km range (man-in-loop), 30 km range (autonomous).

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides the Indian Army with deep-strike precision capabilities up to 30 km without risking frontline troops.; Demonstrates the growing capability of domestic private defence manufacturers in supplying advanced tactical munitions at scale.*

Static — Loitering munitions, often called kamikaze drones, combine the features of a missile and a drone, lingering in the air before slamming into targets. Emergency financial powers granted to the Indian armed forces allow them to fast-track critical military procurements during urgent operational requirements without lengthy regular acquisition cycles. Ammunition depots like Pulgaon serve as crucial central storage facilities for stocking arms, ammunition, and explosive ordnance for the Indian military.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Infrastructure & Energy, Internal Security

Economic Times: read the source · *free copy on msn.com*

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

GOVERNANCE & POLICY AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Ministry of Tribal Affairs and Karmayogi Bharat sign MoU to bring the iGOT Karmayogi learning platform to Adi Karmayogi Volunteers

The Ministry of Tribal Affairs and Karmayogi Bharat signed an MoU to extend the iGOT Karmayogi digital learning platform to Adi Karmayogi Volunteers. The initiative aims to strengthen the implementation of tribal welfare schemes and build grassroots leadership at the village level. It forms part of the Adi Karmayogi Abhiyan, targeting over 76,000 Adi Sewa Kendras and 1.54 lakh volunteers.

PIB: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE REPORT/INDEX AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL), National Culture Fund (NCF) and Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) Sign MoA for Conservation and Development of Heritage Sites

Hindustan Aeronautics Limited, National Culture Fund, and Archaeological Survey of India signed a Memorandum of Agreement for heritage conservation. The agreement was signed to undertake conservation and development works at three prominent heritage sites across India. The core objective is to preserve India's cultural legacy and promote sustainable heritage tourism through public-corporate collaboration.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Odisha Cabinet approves free textbooks for Class IX, X students, Rs. 450 crore skill development scheme

The Odisha Cabinet approved a proposal to provide free textbooks to all Class IX and X students in government and government-aided schools. This decision extends the existing free textbook scheme, which previously covered classes I to VIII and only SC/ST students in classes IX and X. The scheme named 'Supply of Free Textbooks' will run for five years from 2025-26 to 2029-30 at an estimated cost of Rs 284.07 crore.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

HEALTH QUICK READ

Ayush Ministry Releases Treatment Guidelines for Skin Disorders Across Four Traditional Systems

The Union Ayush Ministry released standard treatment guidelines for common skin disorders across Ayurveda, Siddha, Unani and Homoeopathy, along with Yoga. The initiative aims to promote uniformity, quality assurance and evidence-informed clinical practice across traditional healthcare systems following field-level validation. The core issue addressed is the lack of standardized protocols in traditional medicine, bridging system-specific approaches with contemporary scientific evidence for holistic care.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT APPOINTMENT QUICK READ

President Appoints Two Judicial Officers as Additional Judges of Madras High Court

The Central government notified the appointment of two judicial officers as additional judges of the Madras High Court. The newly appointed additional judges are Dharmalingam Lingeswaran and Balathandayutham Karthikeyan. Union Minister of State for Law and Justice Arjun Ram Meghwal announced these appointments on X. The Supreme Court Collegium had recommended both judicial officers for elevation on May 18, 2026.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

India, Czech Republic agree to expand defence industrial cooperation to promote Make in India, Aatmanirbhar Bharat

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and Czech Republic's First Deputy Prime Minister Karel Havlícek reviewed defence industrial cooperation in New Delhi. The two leaders agreed to expand collaboration under the India-Czech Joint Defence Committee to promote Make in India and Aatmanirbhar Bharat. They welcomed ongoing collaboration and the successful establishment of various joint ventures between the two nations.

Economic Times: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Meghalaya Cabinet approves MSME facilitation ordinance to simplify business clearances

The Meghalaya Cabinet approved the promulgation of the Meghalaya Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (Facilitation of Establishment and Operation) Ordinance, 2026. The ordinance is aimed at simplifying regulatory procedures and improving the ease of doing business for entrepreneurs across the state. It seeks to streamline how MSMEs obtain licences, clearances, no-objection certificates, and registrations required to establish and operate businesses.

msn.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

DARPG releases the 50th Report on Centralized Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System (CPGRAMS) for States/UTs for September, 2026

The Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances published its 53rd report for Central Ministries and 50th report for States/UTs tracking monthly grievance disposal. DARPG published its monthly performance reports for September 2026 on CPGRAMS. Central Ministries redressed over 2.38 lakh grievances with an average disposal time of 13 days. The progress for September, 2026 indicates 2,38,579 Grievances redressed by Central Ministries/Departments.

PIB: source

DEFENCE SCHEME QUICK READ

INDIAN NAVY SET TO COMMISSION INDIGENOUS MULTI PURPOSE WARSHIP SAMARTHAK

The indigenous multi-purpose warship Samarthak is scheduled to be commissioned into the Indian Navy on October 16. The commissioning will take place at the Karwar naval base in Karnataka, marking a milestone in defence self-reliance. Built by Larsen and Toubro under the Make in India initiative, Samarthak is the first of four multi-purpose vessels being inducted.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

New plant species discovered in the Nellai Wildlife Sanctuary named after Tamil Nadu

Researchers recently announced the discovery of the new plant species in the Nellai Wildlife Sanctuary. A new plant species has been discovered in the Nellai Wildlife Sanctuary and named in honor of the state of Tamil Nadu.

Research Matters: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE QUICK READ

Goa proposes GI tag for traditional coconut-leaf broom

The proposal was made to officially recognize and protect the traditional coconut-leaf broom unique to Goa. The Goa government has initiated the process to secure a Geographical Indication (GI) tag for the traditional coconut-leaf broom.

Daijiworld: source

ECONOMY ACT/BILL/RULES AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

India notifies strict customs origin rules ahead of India-New Zealand FTA rollout

The Finance Ministry notified the Customs Tariff (Country of Origin) Rules, 2026, ahead of the India-New Zealand Free Trade Agreement rollout. The rules will take effect from October 20, 2026, coinciding with the implementation of the India-New Zealand FTA. The core issue is to ensure that only goods meeting prescribed origin requirements receive customs duty concessions under the trade agreement.

zeebiz.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS SCHEME QUICK READ

India operationalises resident mission in Costa Rica

India has operationalised its new resident mission in Costa Rica's capital city, San Jose. The move aims to expand India's diplomatic footprint in the Central American region. Bilateral ties between India and Costa Rica are experiencing an upswing with a focus on trade and investment. The Ministry of External Affairs announced that the mission became operational with effect from October 10.

The Hindu: source

ECONOMY AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

IBM and MeitY Startup Hub sign MoU to help deep-tech startups turn innovations into commercial solutions

IBM and MeitY Startup Hub signed an MoU to help Indian deep-tech startups develop, test, and commercialise their innovations. The collaboration aims to address the need for startups to validate and scale solutions for Indian and global markets. Startups will gain access to IBM enterprise technology, mentorship, skilling programmes, and industry connections. The agreement includes proof-of-concept projects to help startups test technologies against real business requirements.

tribuneindia.com: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE SCHEME QUICK READ

West Bengal Approves Bhagini Nivedita Scheme

The West Bengal government approved the Bhagini Nivedita Scheme to support unmarried women pursuing higher education. The scheme provides a total financial assistance of Rs. 50,000 distributed over a period of three years. Beneficiaries will receive structured disbursements of Rs. 17,000 in the first year, Rs. 17,000 in the second, and Rs. 16,000 in the third year. The implementation of the Bhagini Nivedita Scheme is officially scheduled to begin in January 2027.

drishtiias.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

India, Canada seek to advance trade pact talks, target year-end deal

Commerce ministers Piyush Goyal and Maninder Sidh discussed the proposed trade agreement following the latest round of negotiations in Canada. India and Canada are working to advance trade pact negotiations with the goal of reaching an agreement by the end of the year.

BusinessLine: source

ECONOMY AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

India, South Korea sign MoU to deepen MSME cooperation

India and the Republic of Korea signed a Memorandum of Understanding to strengthen cooperation in the MSME sector. The agreement was signed during the visit of South Korean President Lee Jae Myung to India on April 20. The MoU was inked between India's Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises and South Korea's Ministry of SMEs and Startups.

ddnews.gov.in: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Validity of Tribunal Appointments Under Hyderabad Act: Supreme Court Confirms

The Supreme Court's confirmation puts to rest questions regarding the legality of tribunal appointments made under the Hyderabad Act. The Supreme Court confirmed the validity of tribunal appointments made under the Hyderabad Act.

The Law Observer: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY QUICK READ

Cabinet approves two elevated corridors worth over Rs. 25,445 crore to decongest Varanasi

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved two major elevated corridor projects in Varanasi worth over Rs. 25,445 crore. The projects aim to ease traffic congestion, improve connectivity, and strengthen multimodal transport infrastructure in the city. The initiatives include a 43.218-km Varuna River Elevated Corridor and a 46.039-km Ganga River Elevated Corridor. Both projects will be executed by the National Highways Authority of India under the Hybrid Annuity Model.

ddnews.gov.in: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Keralam Senior Citizens Bill referred to Assembly Subject Committee

Chief Minister VD Satheesan introduced the Keralam Senior Citizens (Care and Protection of Rights) Bill, 2026, in the Legislative Assembly. The legislation aims to regulate elderly care services, standardise home-based healthcare, and protect senior citizens from neglect and exploitation. The House referred the proposed legislation to Subject Committee VIII for Economic Affairs for detailed consideration following a motion.

The Hindu: source

DEFENCE | QUICK READ

India-Brazil-South Africa Maritime (IBSAMAR) Exercise 2026

Indian Naval Ship Tarkash has been deployed to South Africa to take part in the ninth edition of the India-Brazil-South Africa Maritime Exercise 2026. The trilateral naval exercise is being hosted by South Africa at Simon's Town, Western Cape, from October 8 to October 19, 2026. The exercise aims to enhance interoperability, strengthen maritime cooperation, promote mutual understanding, and advance collective maritime security.

ForumIAS: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | QUICK READ

Bihar Cabinet Approves 5 New Airports and 9 Heliports to Improve Air Connectivity

The Bihar cabinet approved a comprehensive plan to improve regional air connectivity across the state. The proposal includes making five new airports and nine heliports operational in various districts. New airports will be constructed in Kishanganj, Saran, Begusarai, Araria, and Gopalganj districts. Nine heliports will be established in Aurangabad, Banka, Jamui, Katihar, Khagaria, Nawada, Sheikhpura, and Sitamarhi districts.

newindianexpress.com: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SPECIES | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Wild Buffalo Reintroduction in Kanha Tiger Reserve

Madhya Pradesh has started reintroducing wild buffaloes in Kanha Tiger Reserve after they disappeared from state forests for nearly 100 years. The source population of buffaloes was brought from Kaziranga National Park in Assam, covering a distance of approximately 2,200 kilometres. Upon arrival, the buffaloes were kept in a one-hectare quarantine enclosure in the Supkhar range before being shifted to a 17-hectare enclosure.

drishtiias.com: source

ECONOMY | JUDGMENT | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Supreme Court dismisses MMTC's appeal against Rs. 31,950 crore National Spot Exchange settlement

The Supreme Court dismissed an appeal filed by MMTC Limited challenging a settlement scheme resolving creditors' claims from the 2013 National Spot Exchange Limited (NSEL) payment default. The appeal was filed against a March 30 judgment of the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal, which had refused to interfere with the NCLT approval.

Bar & Bench: source

DISASTER MANAGEMENT | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Drought report

The report has been released or discussed in the context of recent seasonal rainfall patterns and agricultural distress. The drought report evaluates rainfall deficits, agricultural stress, and water resource availability to guide relief and policy measures.

Civilsdaily: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 A Common Language for Justice

The debate over making Hindi the official language of the Supreme Court highlights tensions between constitutional authority, judicial efficiency, and public access to justice. Article 348(1)(a) prescribes English for proceedings in the Supreme Court and High Courts unless Parliament enacts a law otherwise. The core issue is balancing the need for judicial consistency and a common legal framework with the linguistic barriers faced by non-English proficient citizens.

The Hindu

GS2 Privacy and transparency: On the RTI Act amendment, petitions

The matter is currently in the news due to ongoing petitions challenging legislative amendments that impact information access and data protection. The editorial discusses the critical balance between transparency and individual privacy in the context of amendments to the RTI Act and pending legal petitions. There must be no information asymmetry between state and citizens

The Hindu

GS2 Israel and the US see Navi Pillay's Peace Prize as a verdict on them

Navi Pillay, a former ICC judge, was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize for her efforts to promote peace and international law. Israel and the US reacted angrily to the award, viewing it as a direct verdict and criticism against them. In September 2025, a UN commission chaired by Pillay concluded that Israeli authorities and security forces had committed genocide against Palestinians in Gaza. Israel termed the Nobel Committee as having lost its moral compass, despite the committee not naming Israel in its announcement.

msn.com

GS3 Nobel Prize 2026: Why Hall and Woodford's economic research resonates in today's world

The announcement of the 2026 Nobel Prize in Economics honoring Robert E. Hall and Michael Woodford put their research in the news. This year's Nobel Prize honours Robert E. Hall and Michael Woodford, whose work draws upon microeconomic studies for a macro policy framework that holds special relevance in a world of high flux and economic shocks. Hear of 'policy reflexivity,' think of this duo.

Mint

GS3 At COP31, climate finance must deliver

COP31 will convene in Antalya from November 9 to 20 amid intensifying climate impacts, strained geopolitics, and deep divisions over climate finance. The authors argue that COP31's success depends on bridging the gap between commitments and delivery through concessional finance, institutions, and bankable project pipelines. The presidency's Action Agenda outlines ten priority themes, featuring a proposed Climate Implementation Bridge to help convert national priorities into investment-ready, bankable projects.

Hindustan Times

GS3 What 3 RBI papers reveal about inflation and Indian households

Recent RBI working papers indicate that household inflation expectations, often viewed as charming exaggerations, actually serve as accurate economic forecasts. Households tend to cluster their inflation responses around round numbers like five, 10, or 15, which linguist Manfred Krifka and economist Carola Binder show signals uncertainty and unease. A 2024 RBI working paper by Purnima Shaw and RK Sinha revealed that these round-number responses contain valuable information about actual inflation trends.

ThePrint

GS3 Mint Quick Edit | Retail investors seem to be going long on India's stock market—as mutual fund data shows

New mutual fund data highlighting household investment trends amid a stock market downturn brought this issue into focus. Recent mutual fund data reveals that Indian retail households are steadily investing money into the stock market despite an ongoing market slump. This speaks of confidence in indices eventually riding back up on the real economy's strength. If the global AI mania subsides, perhaps foreign flows will return.

Mint

GS3 RBI's FX defence: After the swap scheme, back to the barricades

The editorial discusses the RBI's strategic shift in foreign exchange defence following the introduction of the swap scheme. The Reserve Bank of India is changing its foreign exchange defence mechanism by implementing swap schemes to curb currency speculation rather than relying solely on reserve sales. Rather than sell reserves endlessly, the RBI is trying to make speculation expensive, separate genuine trade hedging from financial bets, and buy time for the currency

BusinessLine

GS3 GST reforms aim to boost compliance by removing fear, widening tax base

The GST Council introduced major reforms aimed at boosting compliance by moving toward a trust-based tax administration and removing fear from the system. The recent reforms were triggered by the success of rate rationalisation from the previous year, which led to a surge in gross GST collection and average monthly taxable supply. The core issue being addressed is the cost of visibility for businesses, as fear of stringent measures like arrest kept small traders away from the tax base.

Economic Times

GS2 India's Neighbourhood First policy: Need for strategic recalibration

A decade after its launch, India's Neighbourhood First policy faces severe tests due to political upheavals, changing regional equations, and expanding Chinese influence. The author argues that India must recognize its neighbours seek strategic autonomy rather than assuming geographical proximity and historical ties automatically command loyalty. India cannot counter China merely through financial resources; it must deliver infrastructure on schedule, enhance energy connectivity, and strictly respect regional sovereignty.

Hindustan Times

GS2 Rahul Gandhi is trying to intimidate constitutional authorities, not defend democracy

The editorial argues that opposition actions led by Rahul Gandhi pose a severe threat to democracy by intimidating constitutional authorities. On 12 October, Rahul Gandhi led a march to the Supreme Court and sought a private meeting with Chief Justice of India Surya Kant. A Kerala Congress social media handle posted a tweet demanding the CJI's resignation if he could not handle law-and-order issues, later deleting it. The author views this tweet and the march as a coordinated, covert effort to intimidate the judiciary.

ThePrint

GS3 UPI charges: the economics of a digital public good

It is in the news as discussions emerge on balancing cost recovery, merchant affordability, and financial inclusion for UPI transactions. The editorial examines the economic challenges of sustaining UPI as it transitions from rapid adoption to long-term financial viability, highlighting the need for differentiated pricing. As UPI moves from adoption to sustainability, differentiated pricing must balance cost recovery with financial inclusion, merchant affordability and competition.

Mint

GS3 Ajit Ranade: The 2026 Economics Nobel prize focuses on a macro quest that's far from over

The article discusses the 2026 Nobel Prize in Economics awarded to Robert E. Hall and Michael Woodford for their work reviving Keynesian economics, while noting that macroeconomic stabilization remains an unfinished quest. But this field still has some way to go before we can reliably anticipate and mitigate instability that threatens jobs and livelihoods.

Mint

GS3 When transfer pricing becomes a tax on Global South

The Finance Minister urged BRICS nations to take concrete action on transfer pricing beyond issuing mere communiques. The editorial discusses how current international transfer pricing mechanisms act as an undue tax burden on economies of the Global South. The FM is right to push BRICS on transfer pricing. The numbers show why it cannot stop at a communique

BusinessLine

GS3 Spiralling food prices: on rising inflation

The persistent rise in food prices and its disproportionate impact on rural households put inflation in the news. An editorial highlighting that rural households have felt the greatest impact of rising food inflation. Rural households have felt the greatest impact of rising inflation

The Hindu

GS4 Shield yourself: Judgement is the last human bastion against AI bots ready to take jobs away

Growing workplace experience with deploying artificial intelligence has made it clearer which job functions should not be automated. The editorial argues that fine human judgment is the ultimate defense against AI automation, as bots cannot reliably handle the complex decisions required in senior roles. What AI can't reliably take are fine judgement calls that senior job roles entail. Juniors will need to acquire these skills for employers to value them.

Mint

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

GM Crops in India – Arguments in Favour & Against An industry study shows a quarter or more of India's cotton cultivation area uses unapproved herbicide-tolerant and Bt traits. This indicates high farmer acceptance of HT technology while raising concerns about bypassing government biosafety and regulatory mechanisms. GM crops are plants with DNA altered via genetic engineering to introduce desirable traits from different species.

ForumIAS

2026 Economics Nobel: How to keep an economy stable using policy tools The topic is in the news due to the announcement of the 2026 Economics Nobel Prize. This explainer covers the core concepts behind the 2026 Nobel Prize in Economics, focusing on how policymakers use economic policy tools to maintain stability.

Indian Express

How does the U.S.-Russia diesel deal impact India U.S. President Donald Trump announced the diesel deal alongside an energy ceasefire between Russia and Ukraine. An explainer on the U.S.-Russia diesel deal announced by U.S. President Donald Trump and its potential implications for India.

The Hindu

Inflation generalisation: Why price pressures are spreading, and what it means for interest rates The topic is in the news as an explainer on how spreading price pressures influence central bank interest rate decisions. Inflation generalisation is a market condition where price increases move beyond volatile items like food and fuel to affect a broad spectrum of goods and services, influencing central bank monetary policy.

Indian Express

Tamil Nadu's claim of Cauvery backlog and the Supreme Court's response The failure of the southwest monsoon from June to September has reignited river water tensions. A dispute has arisen between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka regarding Cauvery water sharing and release backlogs. The failure of the southwest monsoon (June-September) this year is the primary reason for the current round of disputes between Karnataka and Tamil Nadu

The Hindu

Why Pakistan declared emergency in Khyber-Pakhtunkhwa The Pakistan government suspended the PTI-led administration in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and imposed governor's rule, escalating political tensions. The trigger was a prolonged confrontation between the Shehbaz Sharif-Asim Munir government and jailed former prime minister Imran Khan's party, PTI.

The Hindu

Why did Brazil President Lula file a complaint against Meta? The action brings renewed focus to Meta's handling of political content and past accusations of election interference. Brazil President Lula filed a complaint against Meta over allegations of election interference involving its platforms. This is not the first time where Meta, formerly Facebook, has been accused of election interference.

The Hindu

Jantar Mantar denotified : From women's suffrage to US anti-immigration, protest sites across the world Jantar Mantar was denotified as a designated protest site, prompting a review of the history of protest spaces. This explainer examines the denotification of Jantar Mantar as a protest site and compares it with historical and global protest venues.
Indian Express

Can South Korea and Ukraine resolve their diplomatic spat? South Korea recalled its ambassador to Kyiv following a sudden and severe deterioration in bilateral ties with Ukraine. The friction began when Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy revealed at the UN General Assembly that Ukraine had transferred two captured North Korean soldiers to South Korea.
msn.com

Why have US-Iran talks over the Strait of Hormuz hit a deadlock? The current diplomatic stalemate over the Strait of Hormuz has put maritime security and oil supplies back in focus. US-Iran talks regarding the Strait of Hormuz have hit a deadlock over security demands and naval maneuvers.
Indian Express

Explained: Why Adani's Mumbai airport, airlines are at odds over flight cuts Adani's Mumbai International Airport Ltd plans to rebuild the ageing north section of Terminal 1B starting in January 2027. The 60-year-old building requires urgent attention following a fire at Terminal 1 in April and identified structural problems.
deccanherald.com

Manufacturing To Blue Economy: How PM Modi's Priority Sectors Could Shape India's Next Wave of Jobs The discussion gained traction as policymakers focus on identifying key growth engines to secure the next wave of employment for India's youth. An analysis of how Prime Minister Modi's priority sectors, notably manufacturing and the blue economy, are poised to drive India's future job creation.
News18

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Ministry of Education, constitutes Three Member Committee to examine student death at IIIT, Ranchi (Education) PIB
- PM Modi meets Canadian Minister Anita Anand; highlights commitment to 'forward-looking strategic partnership' (International Relations) The Hindu
- Rafale beats China's J-16 fighter in Egypt's 'Eagles of Civilization' exercise, Chinese pilots accept fighter jet's edge in dogfight: Report (Defence) Economic Times
- Yenisei River (Geography) ForumIAS
- India-US trade deal: Negotiations 'heading towards a landing point', says Jaishankar (International Relations) Economic Times
- BIMSTEC meeting: India never believes in attacking, establishing supremacy over any country, says Amit Shah (International Relations) The Hindu
- Govt's free trade push could lead to $140 billion GDP gain for India (Economy) Business Standard
- Hon'ble Chairperson National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (NCST) Shri Antar Singh Arya reviewed the implementation of constitutionals safeguards and various programmes for ST's by Ministry of Heavy Industries (Polity & Constitution) PIB
- Pakistan successfully test-fires hypersonic Fatah-2 Extended Range missile (International Relations) Economic Times
- From Limited Income to a More Secure Livelihood (Social Justice & Welfare) PIB
- Improved Soybean Varieties NRC 200 68 and NRC 200 70 Show Promising Signs of Yielding 20 Quintals per Hectare Despite Adverse Weather Conditions (Agriculture & Allied) PIB
- Industrial Pollution Abatement: Sustainability through Regulations under Namami Gange (Environment & Ecology) PIB
- Union Agriculture Minister Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan and Environment Minister Shri Bhupender Yadav conduct joint review of stubble management (Agriculture & Allied) PIB
- Centre asks states to go into 'mission mode' to curb stubble burning as farm fires rise in MP, Rajasthan (Environment & Ecology) Times of India
- MEA reaffirms Ladakh is an integral part of India, says China's denial cannot change facts (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- DRDO to lead thematic session on 'Semiconductors & Next-Gen Chips' at ESTIC-2026 (Science & Technology) PIB
- AI boost bolstered growth in global trade, benefiting China and India: IMF (Economy) BusinessLine
- Keralam introduces country's first elderly care Bill, CM cites Singhania's plight (Social Justice & Welfare) ThePrint
- Indian contingent arrives in Seychelles for joint military exercise Lamitiye 2026 (Defence) DD News
- RBI may hike repo rate by 75 bps, likely to stay on tightening path through H1FY28: Brokerages (Economy) IANS LIVE
- WHO pandemic hub aims to detect new outbreaks within 24 hours by 2030 (Health) Down To Earth
- IMD Launches Interactive Cyclone Warning and Marine Weather Platform (Disaster Management) StratNews Global
- Election Commission launches nationwide campaign to ensure no eligible voter is left out (Polity & Constitution) News On AIR
- RBI to continue efforts to curb rupee volatility; external factors driving currency fall: Nirmala Sitharaman (Economy) The Hindu
- India and UK sign agreement on social security for employees on short-term overseas assignments (International Relations) DD News
- MDR charges on UPI payments will be implemented post-Diwali, says NPCI (Economy) The Hindu

- Centre to review GST reforms with states, plug gaps ahead of April 2027 rollout (Economy) Mint
- Conflict of Interest, Meaning, Types, Examples, Significance (Ethics & Integrity) Vajiram & Ravi
- Tackle drug menace with whole-of-region approach, Shah tells BIMSTEC (Internal Security) The Statesman
- Non-Signatories Can Be Joined In Arbitration If Dispute Affects Their Rights: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw
- Deepening ties with Gulf countries should go hand in hand with derisking (International Relations) Frontline
- India's tit-for-tat Ladakh naming drive irks China; Beijing calls it 'invalid' (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- SC asks govt to expedite regulating prices of life saving drugs (Health) Hindustan Times
- Great Indian Bustard Recovery Faces Major Habitat Challenges (Environment & Ecology) www.usthadian.com
- Supreme Court Says Drug Users Are Victims, Quashes NDPS Prosecution Of Woman Not Found With Contraband (Polity & Constitution) LawChakra
- Doval speaks to Iran NSA, discusses 'latest developments' after ships attacked in Hormuz (International Relations) The Hindu
- MoD to give defence industry 15-year outlook on drones, counter-drone systems (Defence) BusinessLine
- China has a new route into Afghanistan through Wakhan Corridor: Why the road near PoK matters for India (International Relations) Moneycontrol.com
- Madhya Pradesh prepares Supreme Court challenge after High Court strikes down 27% OBC quota in recruitment and colleges (Polity & Constitution) EdexLive
- India's GDPR-Inspired Privacy Law Leaves State Power Unchecked (Polity & Constitution) Tech Policy Press
- SC to government: Cap prices of non-patented medicines (Governance & Policy) Times of India
- PM GatiShakti: over 400 infra projects worth Rs 20.23 lakh cr recommended for approval (Infrastructure & Energy) Economic Times
- Section 161 CrPC Statements Cannot Be Relied On At Trial But Can Be Considered At Cognizance Stage :... (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 13 must-know, 25 Prelims facts, 43 in the news, 16 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Governance & Policy (7), Economy (6), Polity & Constitution (6), International Relations (4), Health (3), Defence (3), History, Art & Culture (2), Environment & Ecology (2), Infrastructure & Energy (2), Science & Technology (1), Social Justice & Welfare (1), Disaster Management (1). **Nothing today in —** Education, Agriculture & Allied, Internal Security, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 3 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 3 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 1 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 1 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 2

Full text — 43 of 66 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 10, PIB 8, Mint 5, BusinessLine 4, Hindustan Times 4, Indian Express 4, drishtiias.com 3, Economic Times 3, msn.com 3, Bar & Bench 2, ddnews.gov.in 2, ForumIAS 2, ThePrint 2, scroll.in 1

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